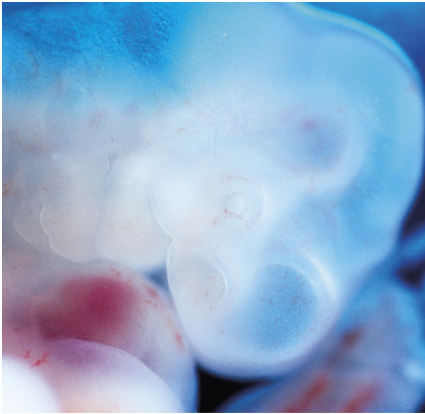




YOU ARE **6 WEEKS AND 2 DAYS**

236 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The first recognizable facial feature to be formed is the eye, visible as a black dot in the center of this image. The gray areas are the fluid-filled chambers of the underlying brain.

“Try not to dwell on your lifestyle before you realized you were pregnant, but start making changes now.”

Have you only just discovered you're pregnant? Not all women realize they are pregnant immediately, especially if it wasn't planned. If you've only just found out, it's natural to be concerned about things that you did before you knew, such as drinking alcohol or taking drugs. You may be worried that you've harmed your unborn baby. Use your pregnancy as an opportunity to assess your lifestyle and improve your health.

Because of how pregnancy is dated (see [Day 1 of your menstrual cycle](#)), your baby is still only a little over four weeks old. If you have not been taking [folic acid](#), start taking supplements starting today.

PRENATAL CARE

The options for prenatal care in the US are outlined in [Types of prenatal care](#), but they do vary from area to area. Whatever your type of prenatal care, any ultrasound scans, tests, and investigations may also take place at a hospital. Your options are likely to be:

- **Group medical practice** with your OB
- **Solo medical practice** midwifery-led
- **Combination practice** if you are high risk
- **Maternity Center-based practice**

GOING SOLO

The prospect of being pregnant and single, especially if it wasn't your choice, can be tough. Here are some useful things to consider:

Take care of yourself: plan a healthy diet, and an exercise routine. Get as much rest as you can. Ask a friend to spur you on or go online and seek support from other single pregnant women locally—you will have a ready-made support network after the birth.

- **Ask for help** from family and friends. You will probably find they are delighted to be involved in your pregnancy and are willing to come to prenatal appointments and classes with you: you may want to consider asking one of these people to be your birth partner.